

Production Incident Response and Escalation SOP

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure ('SOP') defines how NimbusLogix detects, triages, escalates, and resolves production incidents affecting customer-facing services. It is owned by the Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) team and is reviewed quarterly.

2. Severity Definitions

Sev-1: Complete outage of a production service, or data loss / data corruption affecting any customer. All-hands response is mandatory. Page the on-call SRE, the on-call Engineering Manager, and the VP of Engineering within 5 minutes of detection.

Sev-2: Significant degradation of a production service — for example, error rate above 5%, latency above SLO, or a non-critical feature fully unavailable. Page the on-call SRE and the relevant service owner. Target acknowledgement within 15 minutes.

Sev-3: Minor degradation or non-urgent bug. Tracked as a normal engineering ticket; no out-of-hours pages.

3. On-Call Rotation

Primary on-call rotations run for one week, Monday 10:00 to the following Monday 10:00 local time. Each rotation must be staffed by at least 2 engineers, with a designated primary and secondary. The primary must respond within 5 minutes; if no response within 7 minutes, the page escalates automatically to the secondary.

Compensation for on-call duty is governed by the On-Call Compensation Policy: USD 250 per weekday on-call shift, USD 500 per weekend or holiday shift, plus USD 100 per Sev-1 or Sev-2 page acknowledged outside business hours.

4. Customer Support Escalation

Customer support tickets originating from enterprise customers (Tier-1 accounts) that indicate a potential production issue must be escalated to the SRE on-call channel within 15 minutes, regardless of the original ticket severity, by the support agent using the `/sre-escalate` command in Zendesk.

When a support ticket is correlated to an active Sev-1 or Sev-2 incident, the support agent joins the incident Slack channel and acts as the customer liaison. The agent is responsible for posting customer-facing status updates every 30 minutes for the duration of the incident.

5. Post-Incident Review

A blameless post-incident review (PIR) must be completed within 5 business days for every Sev-1 incident and every Sev-2 incident lasting longer than 2 hours. The PIR document is owned by the incident commander and must include: timeline, root cause, contributing factors, customer impact, and a numbered list of follow-up action items with owners and due dates.

Action items from PIRs are tracked in the Engineering Jira project and reviewed in the weekly SRE staff meeting until closed.

6. Communications

External status page updates are mandatory within 15 minutes of Sev-1 declaration and every 30 minutes thereafter until resolution. Internal stakeholder updates go to the #exec-incidents Slack channel and the executive-on-call distribution list. Customer Success Managers are notified by the on-call SRE within 30 minutes and are responsible for direct outreach to impacted enterprise accounts.